

Ember's Pizza Night

A summer story from New England Crust

STORY & PICTURES BY NEW ENGLAND CRUST



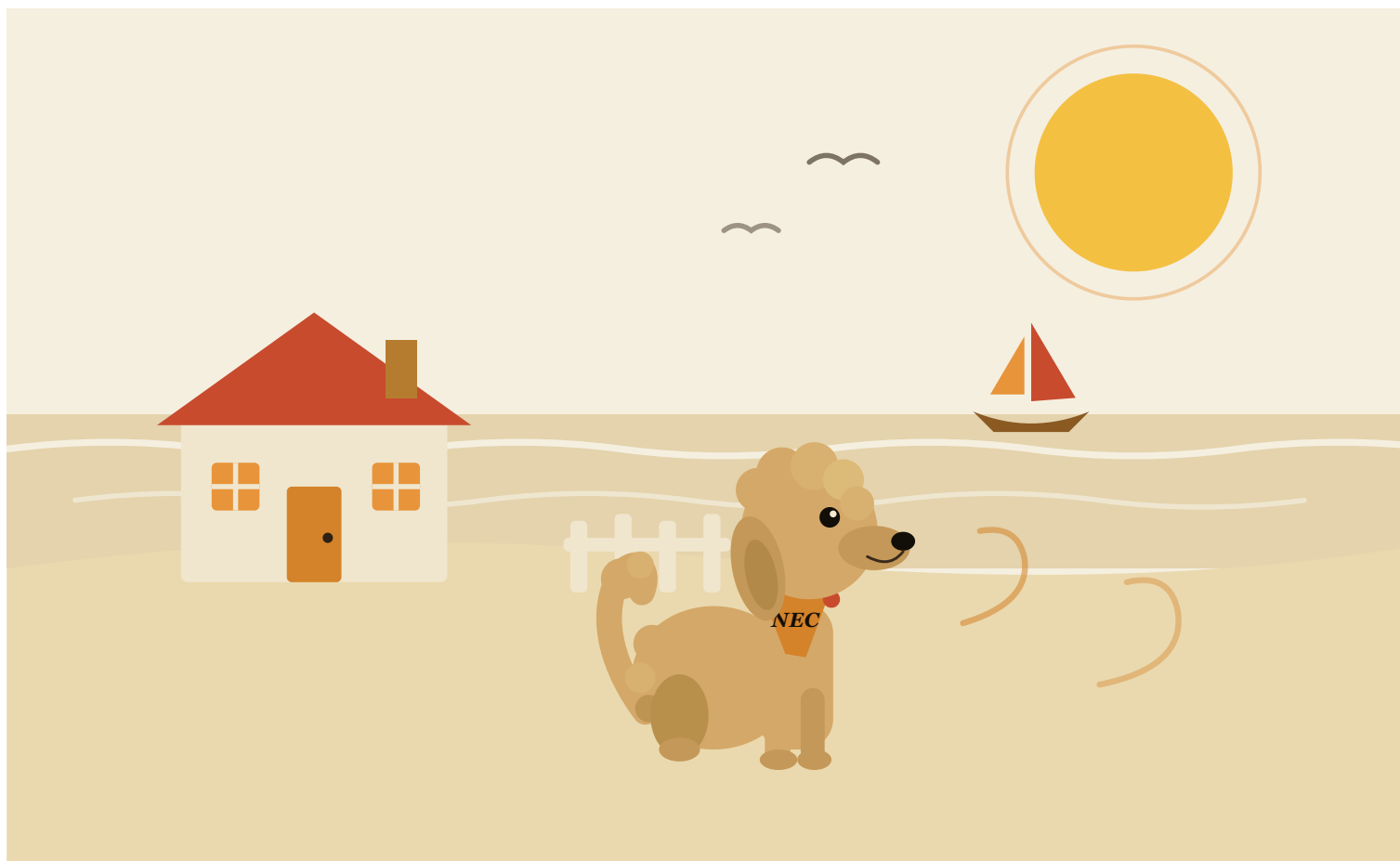


*For every good dog who waits by
the oven.*

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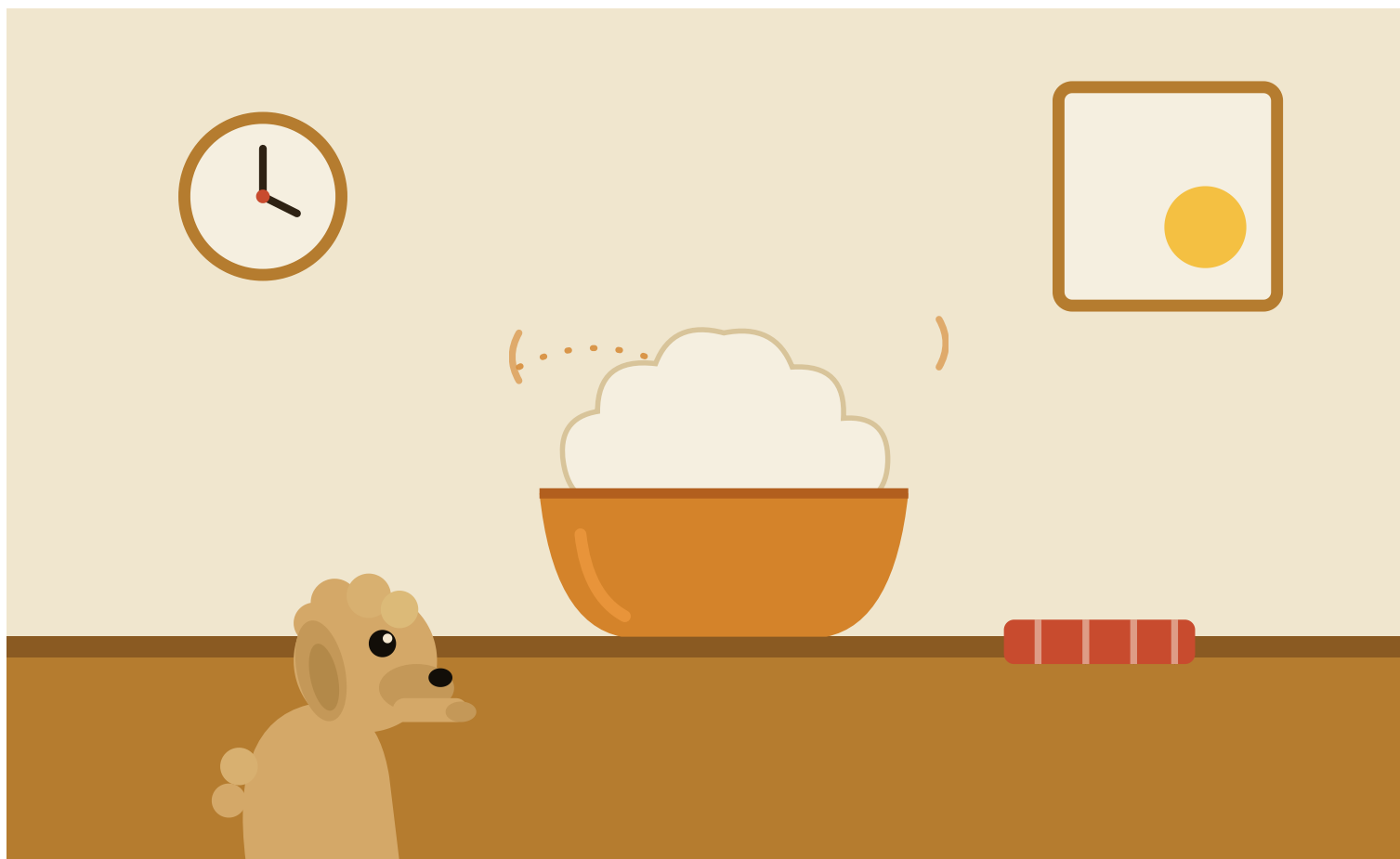
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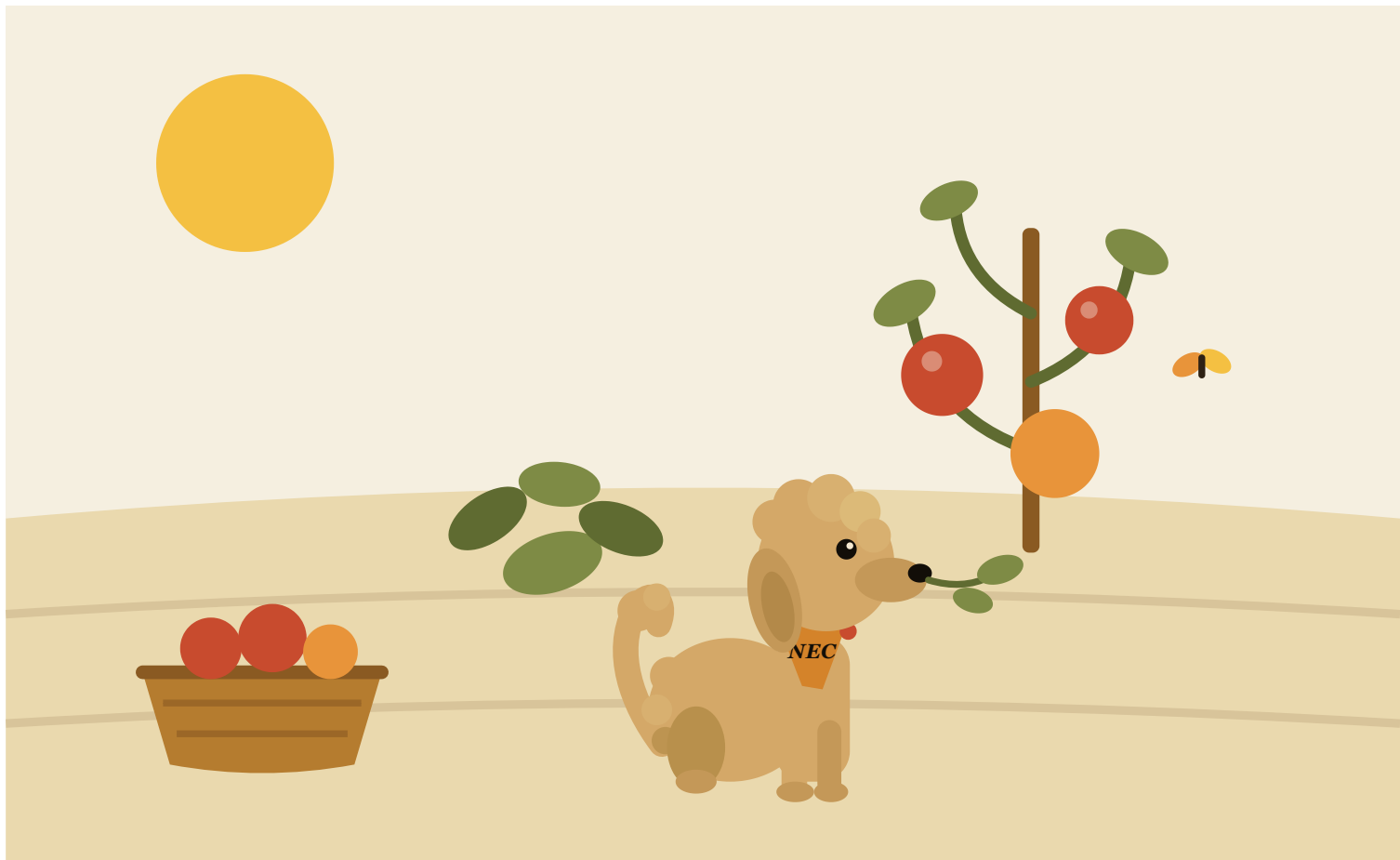
On a little street near the sea, where the salt
air tickles your nose, lives a fluffy golden dog
named Ember.



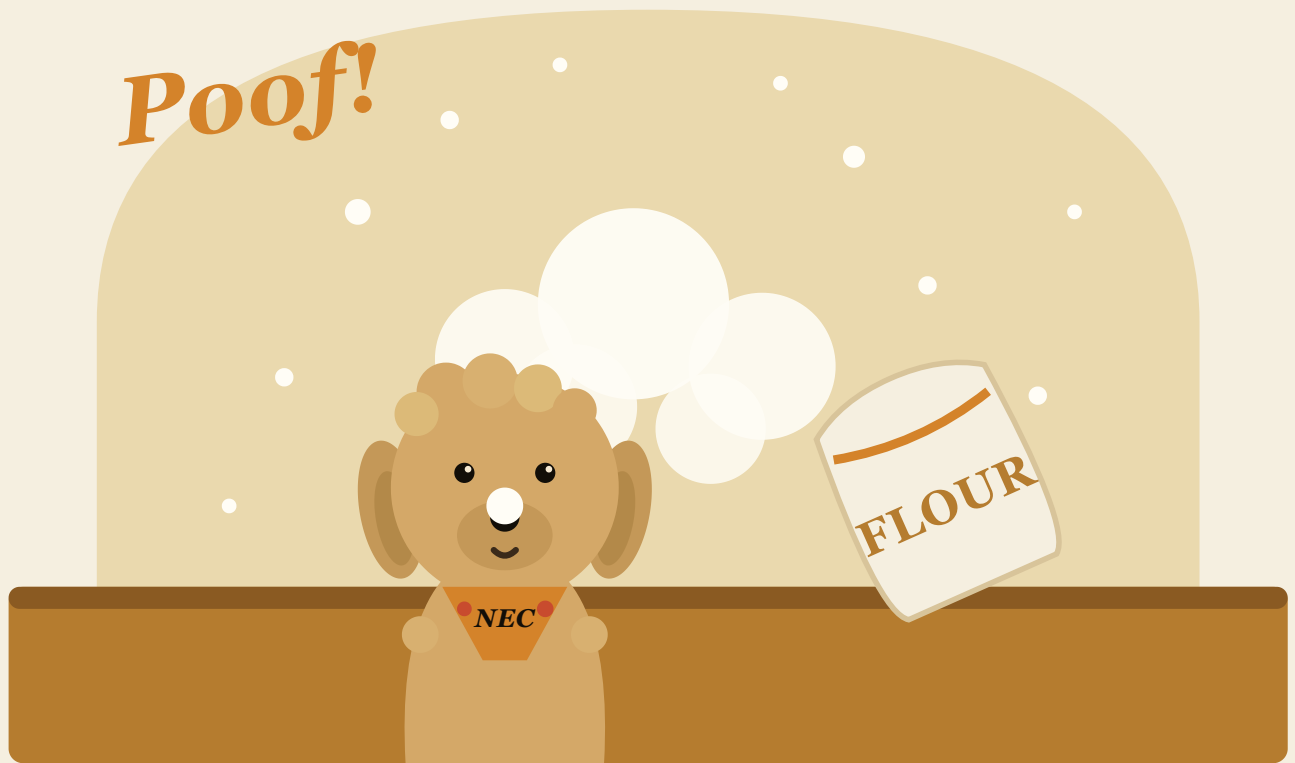
One summer morning, Ember heard the most
wonderful words in the whole wide world:
"Tonight is pizza night!"



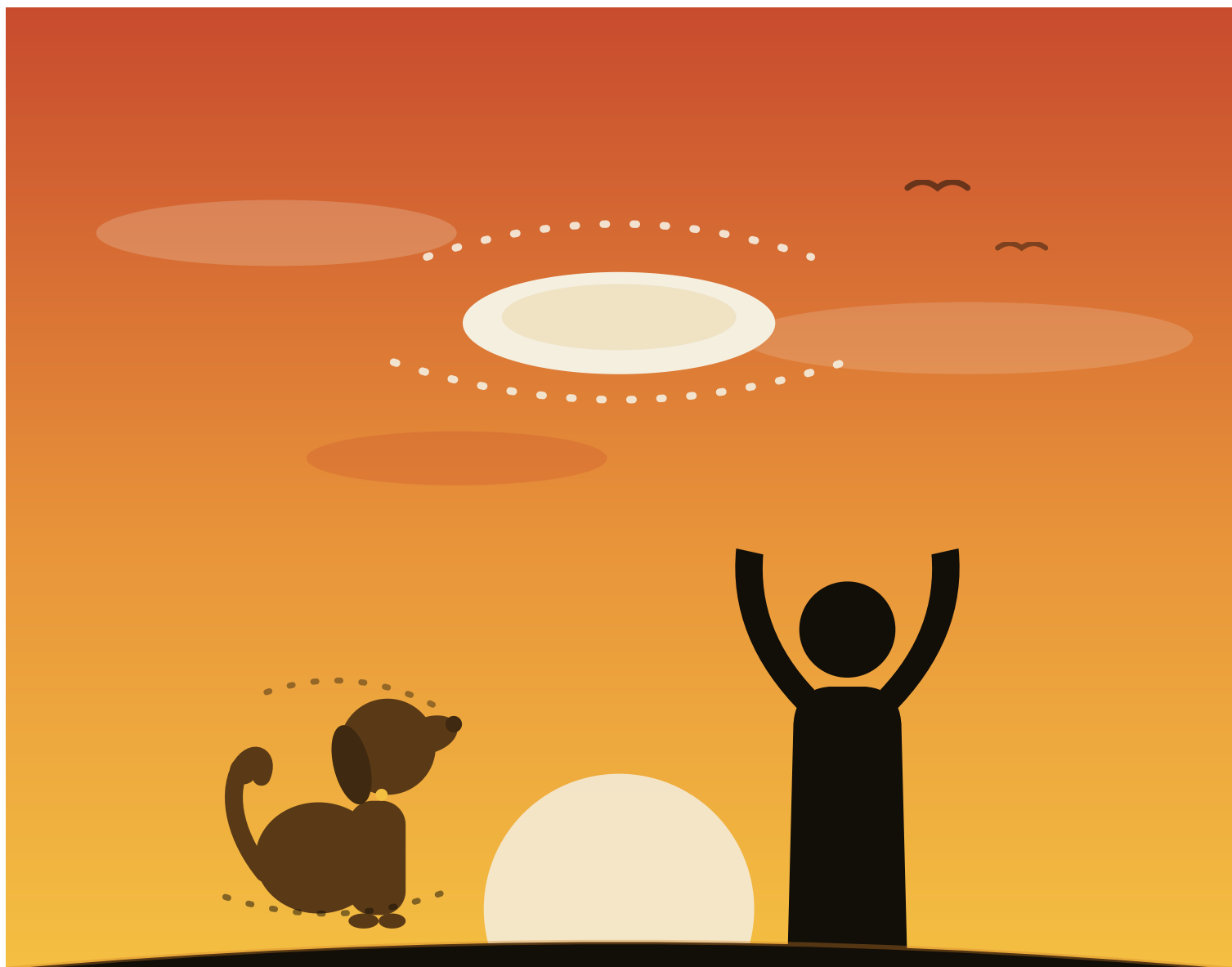
All day long, the dough grew in its bowl, puffy and round as a cloud. Ember watched. And watched. “*Not yet, Ember. Soon, soon, soon.*”



In the garden, Ember helped pick sweet red tomatoes and soft green leaves of basil. “*Good helper, Ember!*”



Then came the flour — poof! It floated down like snow in July. One big white dot landed right on Ember's nose.



Up went the dough, spinning in the air! Round
and round, wide and thin. Ember spun in happy
circles too.





Outside, the little oven crackled and glowed,
warm and amber as a tiny sunset. Ember
sniffed the smoky air. “*Not yet, Ember. Soon,
soon, soon.*”



Whoosh!



Whoosh! The pizza slid in on the shiny peel.

The cheese went bubble, bubble, bubble.

“Not yet, Ember. Soon, soon, soon.”

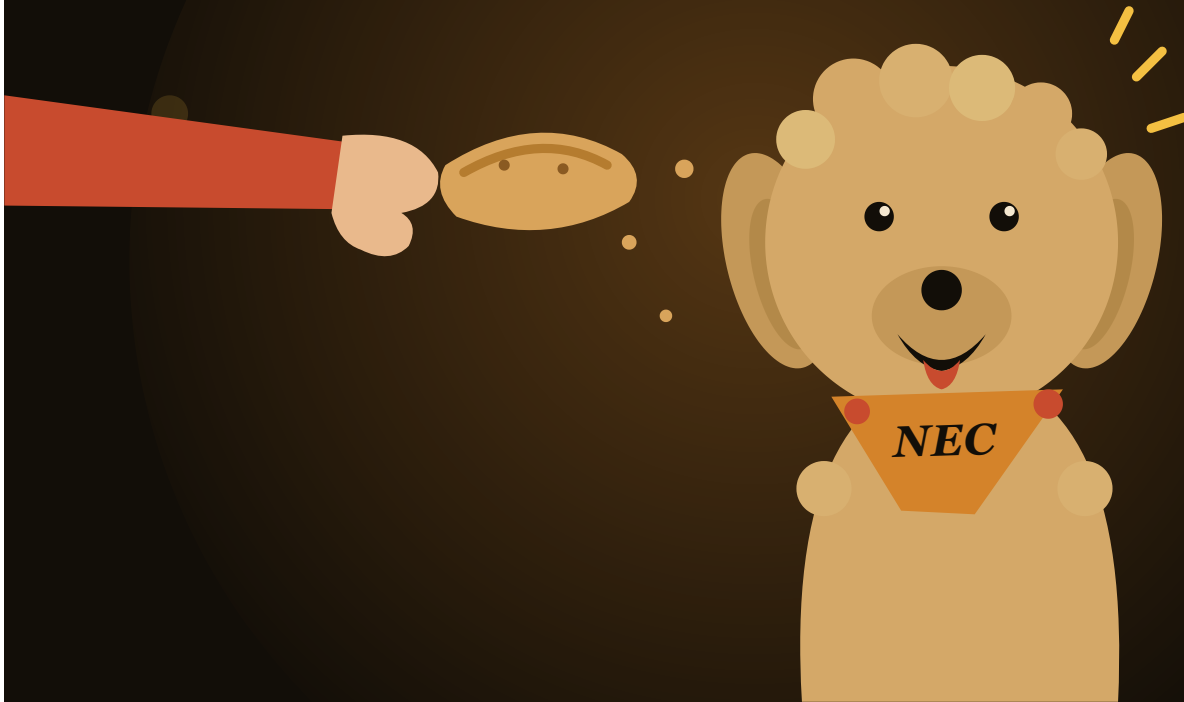




The string lights blinked on. Fireflies came out to visit. Friends filled the picnic table, and Ember's happy tail went thump, thump, thump.



Munch!



And when the very last slice was gone — “*Now, Ember! Now!*” — came the very best part: a warm, crunchy piece of crust. Munch!





The waves hushed. The stars came out one by one.
And Ember fell asleep by the warm little oven,
dreaming of salt air... open flame... and pizza night.



The End

*Sweet dreams, Ember. See you at the
next pizza night.*



NEW ENGLAND CRUST · SALT AIR & OPEN FLAME

